

Impact Medium · Difficulty Easy · Misuse risk Low

THE MOVE

Name the next action -> Who owns it -> By when -> Confirm aloud

START HERE

Before ending any meeting or important conversation, name one specific next action with an owner and a date. Confirm it aloud.

SAY THIS

Next-Step Close Phrases *"Before we close — who is doing what and by when?"*

Confirmation Phrases *"Does everyone agree that is the next step?"*

Quick Closes *"So — who does what by when?"*

Pinning the Owner *"This needs one owner — who is it?"*

Warm Follow-Through *"I do not want this to become one of those 'we must catch up' promises — shall we pick a date now?"*

AVOID

- In open exploratory conversations where closing too early cuts off valuable thinking.
- When the next step is not yet clear — forcing one prematurely creates false closure.
- In relationships where over-formalising the dynamic damages it (some close partnerships, personal relationships).

REMEMBER

The last ninety seconds decide whether the meeting happened.